Figurative Language (Set B)

Year 4 · **Mark Scheme**

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Core Practice

1. Personification (the wind is given the human/animal action of 'howling')
2. Simile (uses 'like' to compare her eyes to diamonds)
3. Alliteration (repeated 'b' sound in 'Busy bees buzzed by the blossoms')
4. Onomatopoeia ('sizzled' imitates the sound)
5. B) simile
6. B) metaphor
7. Personification (leaves are given the human action of 'dancing')
8. C) To do or say something to relieve tension or start a conversation
9. 'pop'
10. A) "She runs like the wind." and C) "He is as cunning as a fox."
11. Alliteration (repeated 's' sound)
12. to accidentally reveal a secret
13. Metaphor (the storm IS described as a monster, with no 'like'/'as')
14. B) onomatopoeia
15. Personification (the moon is given the human action of 'winking')

Applied Practice

16. It suggests the classroom was completely, almost eerily quiet — comparing the silence to the stillness of a graveyard.
17. It suggests his words were sharp and deeply hurtful, as if they physically wounded the listener.
18. Simile ('like an angry giant') and personification (thunder 'grumbled', a human-like sound/action).
19. It means it is now someone else's turn or responsibility to take the next action or decision.
20. B) alliteration
21. B) He took on more responsibilities than he could manage
22. Personification (floorboards given the human action/sound of 'groaning')
23. e.g. "He moved as slowly as a snail crossing a garden."
24. e.g. "The classroom was a zoo."
25. A) "The wind whispered secrets through the trees.", C) "The old house groaned and creaked." and E) "The flowers nodded in the breeze."
26. It means something that happens very rarely.
27. It is a metaphor because the snow is described AS a blanket directly, without using 'like' or 'as'.
28. Onomatopoeia ('Crash! Bang!' imitate the sounds)
29. A) butterflies
30. C) The news shocked and overwhelmed her suddenly

Challenge

31. a rollercoaster has unpredictable ups, downs and sudden turns, just like life's good times, hard times and surprises — the comparison captures both the excitement and the loss of control we feel about the future
32. A and C — alliteration (fierce fire) and personification (fire 'roared')

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33. a simile compares two things using 'like' or 'as' (e.g. 'The snow fell like confetti'); a metaphor says one thing IS another, without 'like'/'as' (e.g. 'The snow was a white carpet')
34. B — to make non-human things feel alive or relatable
35. it means what people do matters more than what they say; e.g. it might be used when someone finally proves a promise through a real act of kindness
36. personification (the screen is given the human action of 'staring')
37. e.g. 'keep it under your hat' (also accept 'button your lip' or 'hold your tongue')
38. personification — the city is given the human trait of never sleeping, making it feel alive and always active
39. B — take the bull by the horns
40. it is figurative/hyperbolic — the silence is so complete and unsettling that it feels as overwhelming as a loud noise, even though silence itself makes no sound
41. personification (opportunity is given the human action of 'knocking')
42. A) 'The old oak tree stretched its branches like weary arms.' and C) 'The wind howled like a wolf through the house.'
43. e.g. 'The exam was a mountain looming ahead of me. Each revision session was another step up its steep slopes.'
44. C — 'He was on cloud nine after failing his test.' ('on cloud nine' means extremely happy, which doesn't fit failing a test)
45. the repeated 'p' sound creates a playful, tongue-twisting rhythm that makes the line fun and memorable to say

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Homework Worksheet — Answers

Core Practice

1. Simile ('like feathers')
2. Onomatopoeia ('clattered and clanged' imitate the sounds)
3. Alliteration (repeated 's' sound)
4. Personification (the sun is given the human action of 'smiling')
5. B) metaphor
6. B) simile
7. B) Something very easy to do
8. Personification (leaves given the human action of 'whispering')
9. 'bang'
10. A) "He is a shining star on the team.", C) "The classroom was a zoo during the party." and E) "Time is a thief, stealing moments away."
11. Alliteration (repeated 'b' sound)
12. feeling slightly unwell
13. Metaphor (her heart IS described as a block of ice)
14. B) onomatopoeia
15. Personification (the car given human actions 'grumbled and groaned')

Applied Practice

16. It suggests the playground was extremely noisy, disorganised and hectic, comparing it to the frenzy of feeding time at a zoo.
17. It suggests her determination was powerful, constant and unstoppable, like a fire that keeps burning.
18. Simile ('like thunder') and personification (waves 'roared', a human/animal-like sound given to the waves).
19. It means someone is being unrealistic or not paying attention to practical matters; daydreaming.
20. C) onomatopoeia
21. B) The final small event that causes someone to lose patience after a series of problems
22. Personification (the wind given the human/animal action of 'biting')
23. e.g. "The playground was as hot as an oven."
24. e.g. "He was a zombie by the end of the school day."
25. A) "The fog crept silently over the hills.", C) "The machine groaned under the strain." and E) "The curtains danced in the gentle breeze."
26. it means something is very expensive
27. It is a metaphor because the classroom IS described as a beehive directly, without using 'like' or 'as'.
28. Onomatopoeia ('Tick-tock' imitates the sound of the clock)
29. A) walk in the park
30. C) Her words deeply hurt his feelings

Standard / Advanced

31. personification — the boat is given the human action of 'battling' the waves
32. it means to make a bad situation worse; it is a kind of hyperbole because it exaggerates the idea of causing further harm ('injury') when usually no real physical injury has occurred
33. personification — the fire is given human body parts ('fingers') and a human action ('crept')
34. 'The children were thunder.'

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35. it means to achieve two goals with one action; someone unfamiliar with idioms might think the sentence describes actually harming birds, rather than understanding it means being efficient
36. (a) 'the house sighed' (b) it creates a sad, slightly eerie mood, as if the house itself is tired or lonely
37. A) up to your eyes, B) have your hands full and D) run off your feet
38. e.g. 'The buzzing bees droned on.' — 'buzzing' and 'droned' are onomatopoeia, and the repeated 'b' in 'buzzing bees' is alliteration
39. B — 'The moon watched over the sleeping village.'
40. e.g. 'Her mind was a cluttered room. Every time she tidied one thought away, three more tumbled in.'
41. B — it personifies the rain, giving it a forceful, human-like action
42. A, B and D are used correctly; C is wrong because struggling for ten minutes contradicts 'piece of cake' (meaning easy); E is wrong because having lived there his whole life contradicts 'fish out of water' (meaning unfamiliar and uncomfortable)
43. combining the two devices creates a single, richer image — the simile sets up the comparison while the personification makes the trees feel alive and purposeful
44. B — cool as a cucumber
45. Simile: 'like a hamster on a wheel' — it reveals that Tom's thoughts feel frantic, repetitive and unproductive

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